

Futures Prop Firm Comparison Report

By: James M. Doyle | Data collected: July 7-8, 2026

Companion files: Project-1-Comparison-Spreadsheet.xlsx, Trader-Decision-Matrix.csv, Sources.csv

1. PURPOSE

This report helps US futures traders compare six major prop firms on a consistent basis. I organized pricing, evaluation rules, risk limits, payout mechanics, and trading restrictions so a new trader can see real trade-offs without reading six different websites. All numbers prioritize official firm sources; PropFirmMatch was used as a cross-check.

2. WHAT I COMPARED

Six US-eligible futures prop firms (Topstep, Apex Trader Funding, Take Profit Trader, MyFundedFutures, Tradeify, Bulenox) across 30+ decision criteria. Primary reference account: \$50K where applicable. Blue Guardian was screened but excluded from the US comparison (UAE entity; US access suspended in 2026).

3. KEY FINDINGS

- Pricing models split three ways: monthly subscription (Topstep, Take Profit Trader, MFFU Core), one-time evaluation fees (Apex 4.0, Tradeify), and one-time activation with no monthly fee (Bulenox Master). Promos heavily affect real entry cost on every firm.
- There is no single cheapest firm for everyone. Apex and Bulenox can reach very low entry with 80-90% codes; MFFU Core starts at \$77/mo; Topstep Combine promos can run near \$49/mo on 50K.
- Risk rules are the main differentiator after price: EOD vs intraday trailing drawdown, daily loss limits, eval vs funded consistency rules, and flat-by times vary materially firm to firm.
- Payout mechanics separate look-alike firms: Take Profit Trader offers daily payouts from day one; MFFU Rapid is daily; Tradeify Select Daily is daily; Bulenox pays weekly (Wednesdays) with a \$1,000 minimum and early payout caps.
- Automation and news rules split traders: Take Profit Trader is manual-only with restricted news windows; Topstep, Apex, Tradeify, and Bulenox allow EAs/API with

conditions; news trading is unrestricted on Tradeify and Bulenox but restricted on Take Profit Trader and most MFFU plans.

- Comparison-site coverage is uneven: Bulenox is not a verified listing on PropFirmMatch, and MFFU Core (\$77/mo) is absent from their catalog (detailed in Project 3 audit).

4. FIRM-BY-FIRM SNAPSHOT

Topstep - Established Chicago-based firm. Monthly Combine model with Express Funded path. Standout: No Activation Fee Combine path and ProjectX API (\$29/mo). Watch for: daily loss limit, early 3:10 PM CT flat time, and \$149 funded activation. Best for: traders who want a long track record and optional API automation.

Apex Trader Funding - One-time eval fees under Apex 4.0 (no monthly reset). Standout: 100% of first \$25K profit, up to 20 accounts, heavy promos (80-90% off). Watch for: 30-day eval window, 50% funded consistency, metals suspended, and frequent program changes. Best for: promo-focused traders scaling multiple accounts.

Take Profit Trader - Three-tier path (Test -> PRO -> PRO+). Standout: daily payouts from day one, no daily loss limit on funded (removed Jan 2025), simple reputation. Watch for: \$130 PRO activation, manual trading only (no bots), and strict news blackout windows around FOMC/NFP/CPI. Best for: discretionary traders who prioritize fast payouts.

MyFundedFutures - Multiple plan tiers (Core, Rapid, Pro, Flex, Builder). Standout: \$0 activation, Core entry at \$77/mo, Rapid daily payouts, dxFeed included. Watch for: plan complexity, news restrictions on most tiers, and per-payout fees (\$15). Best for: budget-conscious traders who want plan flexibility.

Tradeify - Growth, Select, and Lightning programs with one-time eval pricing. Standout: 40% promos, 90/10 split, Select Flex/Daily funded has no consistency rule, news allowed. Watch for: September 2025 rule changes (DLL/consistency vary by SKU). Best for: traders who want promo pricing and program choice.

Bulenox - One-time Master activation (no monthly). Standout: 100% of first \$10K profit, EAs allowed, deep promo codes (up to 89% off). Watch for: \$1,000 minimum payout, weekly-only cadence, first-three payout caps, and mixed denial reports. Best for: one-time-fee seekers comfortable with slower payouts. Not listed on PropFirmMatch.

5. DATA-ACCURACY NOTES

Official firm websites were treated as the source of truth. Where PropFirmMatch disagreed, I recorded the official value and flagged the gap. Examples found during cross-check

(expanded in Project 3): Apex FAQ still lists removed 4.0 rules (5:1 risk-reward, 30% consistency); MFFU Core plan missing from PFM; Take Profit Trader promo wording on activation fees is misleading; Bulenox has no verified PFM listing. Several activation and reset fees remain VERIFY at checkout due to promo-dependent pricing tables.

6. SOURCES

- Topstep: <https://www.topstep.com/> (checked 2026-07-07)
- Apex Trader Funding: <https://apextraderfunding.com/> (checked 2026-07-07)
- Take Profit Trader: <https://takeprofittrader.com/> + Zendesk PRO rules (checked 2026-07-07)
- MyFundedFutures: <https://myfundedfutures.com/> + Builder help center (checked 2026-07-07)
- Tradeify: <https://tradeify.co/funded-trader-agreement> (checked 2026-07-07)
- Bulenox: <https://bulenox.com/help/master-account/> (checked 2026-07-07)
- Cross-check: <https://propfirmmatch.com/futures> (checked 2026-07-08 in Project 3)

Full source log: Sources.csv | Detailed field-by-field matrix: Trader-Decision-Matrix.csv